

YILAN ANNIE GAO

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PMP • CSM • M.Ed. • M.P.I. | Bilingual English & Mandarin

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- **12 years of Program Management excellence** specialized in driving cross-functional alignment and structured response during high-stakes regulatory shifts, safety incidents, and high-visibility product events.
- **Expert in Rapid Response & Crisis Ops:** Proven track record building escalation frameworks, response playbooks, and automated protection systems from zero in high-consequence technology environments.
- **Strategic Cross-Functional Leader:** Experienced in bridging Engineering, Trust & Safety, Policy, and Legal teams to translate complex technical/compliance mandates into actionable executive narratives.
- **Global Operations Expert:** Deep experience managing multi-regional programs across the US, China, and Japan, with a focus on localizing safety and integrity requirements for global scale.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations & Policy Ops Roblox | Feb 2023 – Present
Rapid Response & Platform Integrity (2025–Present)

- **Incident Response Leadership:** Serve as the primary cross-functional lead for policy and compliance incidents affecting Roblox's most high-value accounts; lead end-to-end response coordination across Engineering, Safety, and Legal during critical regulatory cycles.
- **Playbook Development:** Built False-Moderation Protection System from the ground up, defining risk tiers, escalation workflows, and response protocols that reduced wrongful takedowns by 15% in the first quarter.
- **AI & Safety Auditing:** Collaborated with Engineering to audit AI-based content detection tools; established feedback loops to validate detection accuracy against live content, improving automated review reliability for the platform's top creators.
- **Executive Communication:** Present real-time risk assessments and strategic trade-offs to VP and C-suite leadership; translate complex safety requirements into clear, actionable guidance for external stakeholders.

LiveOps & Incident Management (2024)

- **Zero-Failure Execution:** Program-managed 5 platform-wide live events (10M+ concurrent players each), overseeing full-cycle risk planning, real-time incident escalation, and vendor management in high-velocity windows.
- **Data Synthesis:** Translated real-time performance analytics into executive-level "Post-Mortem" reports, identifying root causes of technical friction and driving process improvements for future launches.

International Expansion & Creator Support (2023)

- **Global Ecosystem Management:** Supported UGC developer communities across China, Japan, and Latin America with tailored onboarding, partner communications, and localized engagement strategies.
- **Feedback Loop Systems:** Co-designed a structured developer feedback system with the PMM team, embedding community insights into the global product development cycle to ensure international nuances shaped product safety and policy decisions upstream.

Senior Program Manager, Strategy & Operations Roblox China | Mar 2021 – Feb 2023

- **Regulatory Liaison:** Orchestrated cross-functional communications aligning China's complex regulatory/compliance requirements with Global HQ product roadmaps; built the "Moderation Gateway" to eliminate bottlenecks for top-tier content.
- **GTM Strategy:** Defined the launch framework for the China market, including integrity readiness and post-launch risk monitoring infrastructure; negotiated data access frameworks with US Finance and Legal teams.

Partnership Programs Lead California State University, San Bernardino | Apr 2019 – Apr 2021

- Managed a \$4M portfolio of institutional partnerships; achieved 100% program renewal and 60% growth through proactive stakeholder management and operational redesign.

China Programs Manager Virginia Commonwealth University | Jul 2014 – Mar 2019

- Led international market entry strategies, achieving 300% enrollment growth and managing 5 signature programs across 10+ campus departments.

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

- **Methodologies:** Rapid Response Playbook Development, Escalation Framework Design, PMP (PMI), Certified Scrum Master (CSM), Agile, GTM Strategy, Risk Mitigation.
- **Tools:** AI Workflow Automation (Gemini, Claude, ChatGPT), Jira, Confluence, Excel.
- **Languages:** English, Mandarin Chinese.

EDUCATION

- **Master of Product Innovation** | Virginia Commonwealth University | 2018
- **Master of Education – Adult Learning & HRD** | Virginia Commonwealth University | 2014
- **Bachelor of Arts – English & International Relations** | Sichuan International Studies University | 2012